

List of Kanji

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漢字 1: Near (近)

近		
Near.		
The sense of <i>recent</i> is also incorporated.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	斤 + 辵
English	Axe + Walk/Road

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Nearly	got [axed] on the [road].

♪ Pronunciations	
音読み	訓読み
Cm. キン (KIN)	ちか (chika)
L.C. —	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations	
Near	⟨KINDRED⟩ to us are the <chickadees>.
‡Chickadees are a group of North American birds in the tit family.	

漢字 2: Lose (失)

失		
Lose, in the sense of <i>mislay</i> .		
This character often conveys a hint of <i>failure and error</i> .		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	人 + 大
English	Person + Large

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Losing	[people] is a [big] loss.

♪ Pronunciations	
音読み	訓読み
Cm. シツ (SHITSU)	うしな (ushina)
L.C. —	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations	
Lose	your ⟨SHEETS⟩ until <you shine>.

+ Words and Compounds

近い	near	ちかい (chikai)
近々	shortly	ちかぢか (chikajika)
近づく (intr.)	to approach	ちかづく (chikazuku)
近道	near + road = shortcut	ちかみち (chikamichi)
近親	near + parent = close relative	キンシン (KINSHIN)
最近	most + near = recently	サイキン (SAIKIN)
近所	near + location = neighbourhood	KIN-JO (KIN-JO)
近代	near + substitute = modern/recent times	キンダイ (KIN-DAI)
接近	join + near = getting closer	セツキン (SEK-KIN)

{...} Sample Sentence

新しい	家	は	川	の	近く	に	あります。
あたらしい	いえ	は	かわ	の	ちかく	に	あります
new	house	は	river	の	near	に	is
The new house is near a river.							

+ Words and Compounds

失う (tr.)	to lose	うしなう (ushinau)
見失う (tr.)	see + lose = to lose sight of	みうしなう (miushinau)
失言	lose + say = slip of the tongue	シツゲン (SHITSU-GEN)
失明	lose + bright = going blind	シツメイ (SHITSU-MEI)
失業	lose + business = unemployment	シツギョウ (SHITSU-GYŌ)
失神	lose + god (mind) = faint; stupefaction	シッシン (SHISSHIN)
失礼	lose + courtesy = discourtesy; impoliteness	シツレイ (SHITSU-REI)

{...} Sample Sentence

大会	で	失言	しました。
タイカイ	で	シツゲン	しました
convention	で	slip of the tongue	did
(I) made a slip of the tongue at the convention.			

漢字 5: Week (週)

週	週	
Week.		

∈ Composition

Glyphs	周 + 辵
English	Around (??) + Walk/Road

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Weeks	of 「walking」 「around」.
-------	------------------------

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	シュウ (SHŪ)	—
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Weekly	〈SHOES〉.
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+ Words and Compounds

週間	week + interval = <i>week</i>	シュウ・カン (SHŪ-KAN)
一週間	one + week + interval = <i>one week</i>	イチ・シュウ・カン (ISSHŪ-KAN)
二週間	two + week + interval = <i>two weeks</i>	ニ・シュウ・カン (NISHŪ-KAN)
週日	week + sun (day) = <i>weekday</i>	シュウ・ジツ (SHŪ-JITSU)
先週	precede + week = <i>last week</i>	セン・シュウ (SENSHŪ)
来週	come + week = <i>next week</i>	ライ・シュウ (RAISHŪ)

{...} Sample Sentence

来週	また	会いたい。
ライシュウ	また	あいたい
next week	again	to meet
<i>I'd like to see you again next week.</i>		

漢字 6: Pull (引)

引	引	
Pull.		

This character also conveys the idea of *attraction* (best seen in the fourth example), and the sense of *receding* and *withdrawing*.

You will notice it frequently on signs; it indicates *pull* on doors, and *discount* when used with numbers.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	弓 + 丨
English	Bow + Line/Pole/Vertical stroke

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Pull	the 「bow」 in a straight 「line」.
------	---------------------------------

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	イン (IN)	ひ (hi)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Pull	〈heaps〉 of 〈INK〉.
------	-------------------

+ Words and Compounds

As seen in the third example, this is another 漢字 that can act like 買. The 訓読み can also become voiced in the second position, as happens in the fifth compound.

引く	<i>to pull</i>	ひく (hiku)
引き出す	pull + exit = <i>to withdraw (something)</i>	ひき だす (hiki dasu)
引出し	pull + exit = <i>a withdrawal; a drawer</i>	ひき だし (hiki dashi)
引力	pull + strength = <i>gravitation</i>	イン・リョク (IN-RYOKU)
万引き	ten thousand + pull = <i>shoplifter</i>	マン びき (MAN biki)
引き受ける	pull + receive = <i>to undertake</i>	ひき うける (hiki ukeru)
引き上げる	pull + upper = <i>to pull up</i>	ひき あげる (hiki ageru)

{...} Sample Sentence

引力	が	惑星	を	引き付ける。
インリョク	が	ワクセイ	を	ひきつける
gravitation	が	planets	を	to attract
<i>Gravity binds the planets to the sun.</i>				

漢字 7: Second (秒)

		
Second (of time or arc).		

∈ Composition

Glyphs	禾 + 少
English	Two-branch tree/Grain + Few (??)

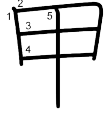
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Seconds	until a [few] [crops] remained.
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♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ビョウ (BYŌ)	—
L.C.	—	—

漢字 8: Shell (甲)

		
Shell.		
This character rarely appears on its own, but proves valuable as a component.		

∈ Composition

Glyphs	田
English	Rice field

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Shells	in the [rice field].
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♣♣ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Seconds	untill it will <BE YOURS>.
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+ Words and Compounds

一秒	one + second = <i>one second</i>	イチ・ビョウ (ICHI·BYŌ)
五秒	five + second = <i>five seconds</i>	ゴ・ビョウ (GO·BYŌ)
秒読み	second + read = <i>countdown</i>	ビョウ よみ (BYŌ yomi)

{...} Sample Sentence

十五分	二十秒	掛かりました。
ジュウゴフン	ニジュウビョウ	かかりました
15 minutes	20 seconds	took
<i>It took fifteen minutes and twenty seconds.</i>		

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	コウ (KŌ)	—
L.C.	カン (KAN)	—

♣♣ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Shells	<CAUSE> <CUNNING> schemes.
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+ Words and Compounds

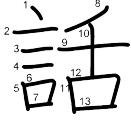
手の甲	hand + shell = <i>back of the hand</i>	ての・コウ (teno·KŌ)
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{...} Sample Sentence

上田さん	は	手の甲	が	かゆい。
うえださん	は	ての・コウ	が	かゆい
Ueda-san	は	back of hand	が	itchy
<i>The back of Ueda's hand is itchy.</i>				

Let's meet near the east entrance at eight-thirty.

漢字 11: Speak (話)

話		
Speak, along with the ideas of <i>conversations</i> and <i>stories</i> .		

∈ Composition

Glyphs	言 + 舌
English	Say/Speaking/Speech + Tongue

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

“Speak”, [says] the [tongue].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ワ (WA)	はなし、はな (hanashi, hana)
As in the final example below, the 訓読み for this 漢字 is always voiced in the second position.		
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Speak of how <hung-up> <Hanah shielded> us from being (WASHED).

+ Words and Compounds

話	story	はなし (hanashi)
話す	to speak	はなす (hanasu)
話し好き	speak + like = talkative	はなし ずき (hanashi zuki)
電話	electric + speak = telephone	デン・ワ (DEN-WA)
会話	meet + speak = conversation	カイ・ワ (KAIWA)
立ち話	stand + speak = chatting while standing	たち ばなし (tachi banashi)

{...} Sample Sentence

君	に	電話	です。
きみ	に	デンワ	です
you	に	telephone	be / is
You are wanted on the phone.			

漢字 12: English (英)

英		
English. A secondary meaning relates to <i>brilliance</i> .		

∈ Composition

Glyphs	艸 + 央
English	Grass + Center (??)

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Brilliant English [grass] is in the [centre].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	エイ (EI)	—
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

English <AIM> for world domination.

+ Words and Compounds

英語	English + words = English language	エイ・ゴ (EIGO)
英国	English + country = England	エイ・コク (EIKOKU)
英会話	English + meet + speak = English conversation	エイ・カイ・ワ (EIKAIWA)
日英	sun + English = Japan and England	ニチ・エイ (NICHIEI)

{...} Sample Sentence

私	は	英語	が	読める。
わたし	は	エイゴ	が	よめる
I	は	English	が	to read
I am able to read English.				

漢字 13: Instruction (訓)

訓	訓	
Instruction.		
This 漢字 tends to give a more serious or spiritual sense of <i>teaching</i> to the compounds in which it appears.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	言 + 川
English	Say/Speaking/Speech + River

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Instruct the [river] to [say] something.

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	クン (KUN)	—
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations
Instruct the <RACCOON>?!

+ Words and Compounds		
訓読み	instruction + read = <i>the kun-yomi</i>	クン よみ (KUN yomi)
訓話	instruction + speak = <i>moral discourse</i>	クンワ (KUN·WA)

{...} Sample Sentence					
これ	を	訓読み	で	読んで	下さい。
これ	を	クンよみ	で	よんで	ください
this	を	kun-yomi	で	read	please
<i>Please read this with kun-yomi.</i>					

漢字 14: Push (押)

押	押	
Push. Suppression. Restraint.		
This 漢字 also serves as the partner to 引 (Entry 6, page 5) on door signs.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	手 + 田
English	Hand + Rice field

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Push your [hand] into the [rice fields].

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	—	お (o)
L.C.	オウ (OU)	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations
Pushing can be <AWEFULLY> <obligatory>.

+ Words and Compounds		
As indicated by the last two examples below, this is another 漢字 that often shows up in the manner of 買.		
押す	<i>to push</i>	おす (osu)
押し出す	push + exit = <i>to push out</i>	おし だす (oshi dasu)
押し上げる	push + upper = <i>to push up</i>	おし あげる (oshi ageru)
押し開ける	push + open = <i>to push open</i>	おし あける (oshi akeru)
押入れ	push + enter = <i>closet</i>	おし いれ (oshi ire)
押売	push + sell = <i>high-pressure sales</i>	おしうり (oshiuri)

{...} Sample Sentence					
押入れ	の	中	に	物	が 少ない。
おしいれ	の	なか	に	もの	が すくない
closet	の	middle	に	things	が few
<i>There aren't many things in the closet.</i>					

漢字 15: Year (年)

年	年	
Year.		

∈ Composition

Glyphs	人 + 年
English	Person + WI (wheel...)

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Year	of [people] [wheeling] around in circles.
------	---

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ネン (NEN)	とし (toshi)
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The **year** the <NENETS> acquired <Toshiba>.

[‡]*Nenets* is an ethnic group native to Northern Arctic Russia. [‡]*Toshiba* is a semiconductor company and the inventor of flash memory. It is headquartered in Tōkyō.

+ Words and Compounds

年	<i>year</i>	とし (toshi)
年上	year + upper = <i>older</i>	としようえ (toshiue)
年下	year + lower = <i>younger</i>	としした (toshishita)
新年	new + year = <i>the New year</i>	シン・ネン (SHIN·NEN)
中年	middle + year = <i>middle age</i>	チュウ・ネン (CHŪ·NEN)
一年生	one + year + life = <i>first-year student</i>	イチネン・セイ (ICHINENSEI)

{...} Sample Sentence

青木さん	は	三年生	です。
あおきさん	は	サンネンセイ	です
Aoki-san	は	third year	be / is
<i>Aoki-san is a third-year student.</i>			

漢字 16: Come (来)

来	来	
Come.		
As the final four compounds below make clear, the related meanings of <i>next</i> is also included.		

∈ Composition

Glyphs	一 + 米
English	One + Rice

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Come	[one] [rice] grain at a time.
------	-------------------------------

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	アイ (RAI)	く (ku)
L.C.	—	き、こ (ki, ko)

This character is infamous for being one of the only two irregular verbs in Japanese. The character can be read variously as く, き, or こ, depending on which tense of the verb is being used. An important exception is found in the second compound below (also an extremely common word): when following 出, 来 is always read as き.

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Come up with a <coup> to <keep> on <RHYMING> with <cobble>.

+ Words and Compounds

来る	<i>to come</i>	くる (kuru)
出来る	exit + come = <i>to be able to</i>	で きる (de kiru)
来週	come + week = <i>next week</i>	ライ・シュウ (RAISHŪ)
来月	come + moon = <i>next month</i>	ライ・ゲツ (RAIGETSU)
来年	come + year = <i>next year</i>	ライ・ネン (RAINEN)
来春	come + spring = <i>next spring</i>	ライ・シュン (RAISHUN)

{...} Sample Sentence

The sentence below is an example of the polite past tense.				
先生	は	一週間	前	に 来ました。
センセイ	は	イッシュウカン	まえ	に きました。
teacher	は	1 week	before	に came
<i>The teacher came a week ago.</i>				

漢字 17: Study (学)

学	学	
Study. Learning.		
When used as a suffix, it is often equivalent to the English <i>-ology</i> . The final compound offers such an example.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	子 + 小 ^{㇀㇁㇂} + 冫
English	Child + Small + Cover/Crown

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Study	the [small] hair [crowns] of [children].

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ガク (GAKU)	まな (mana)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Study	how to <manage> all this <GUCK>.
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+ Words and Compounds

学ぶ	to study	まなぶ (mana-bu)
大学	large + study = <i>university</i>	ダイ・ガク (DAI-GAKU)
学生	study + life = <i>student</i>	ガク・セイ (GAKUSEI)
休学	rest + study = <i>absence from school</i>	キュウ・ガク (KYŪ-GAKU)
語学	words + study = <i>linguistics</i>	ゴ・ガク (GO-GAKU)
生物学	life + thing + study = <i>biology</i>	セイ・ブツ・ガク (SEIBUTSU-GAKU)

{...} Sample Sentence

この	家	に	は	大学生	が	多い。
この	いえ	に	は	ダイガク セイ	が	おおい。
this	house	に	は	university students	が	many
There are many university students in this house.						

漢字 18: Mind (意)

意	意	
Mind. Thought.		
This abstract character appears in many compounds conveying the ideas of <i>will</i> , <i>intention</i> , and <i>opinion</i> , etc.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	音 + 心
English	Sound + Heart

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Mind	[resonating] with [heart].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	イ (I)	—
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Mind	the <INDICATORS>.
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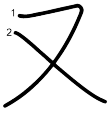
+ Words and Compounds

意思	mind + think = <i>(one's) intent</i>	イ・シ (ISHI)
意図	mind + diagram = <i>(one's) aim</i>	イ・ト (ITO)
意外	mind + outside = <i>unforseen</i>	イ・ガイ (IGAI)
*意見	mind + see = <i>opinion</i>	イ・ケン (IKEN)
意気	mind + spirit = <i>morale</i>	イ・キ (IKI)
注意	pour + mind = <i>attention</i>	チュウ・イ (CHŪ-I)

{...} Sample Sentence

あなた	の	意見	が	分かりません。
あなた	の	イケン	が	わかりません
you	の	opinion	が	don't understand
I don't understand your opinion.				

漢字 19: Again (又)

		
Again. Also.		
This 漢字 rarely appears on its own.		
The suggested visual mnemonic is an <i>ironing board</i> .		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	又
English	Again

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Part of the 漢字 radicals (#29).

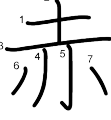
♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	—	また (mata)
L.C.	—	—

♣♣ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations
Again and again the <matador> irked the bull.
‡A <i>matador</i> is a bullfighter whose task is to kill the bull.

+ Words and Compounds		
Note how the second 漢字 in the final example below is voiced.		
又	<i>again</i>	また (mata)
又々	again + again = <i>once again</i>	また・また (mata-mata)
又聞き	again + hear = <i>hearsay</i>	また・ぎき (mata-giki)

{...} Sample Sentence				
The pronunciation of 来なかった below is the informal past tense reading of 来.				
北川さん	は	又	来なかった	よ。
きたがわさん	は	また	こなかった	よ
Kitagawa-san	は	again	didn't come	よ
<i>Kitagawa-san didn't come again!</i>				

漢字 20: Red (赤)

		
Red.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	赤
English	Red

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Part of the 漢字 radicals (#155).

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	セキ (SEKI)	あか (aka)
L.C.	シャク (SHAKU)	—

♣♣ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations
Red is <also known as> <SEXY>. <SHUCKS>!

+ Words and Compounds		
赤	<i>red (noun)</i>	あか (aka)
赤い	<i>red (adjective)</i>	あかい (akai)
赤ちゃん	<i>baby</i>	あかちゃん (aka-chan)
赤道	red + road = <i>equator</i>	セキ・ドウ (SEKIDŌ)

{...} Sample Sentence			
木の葉	が	赤く	なった。
きのは	が	あかく	なった
foliage	が	red	to become
<i>The leaves of the trees have turned red.</i>			

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C			L			Push	押	9	Time	時	7
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						Shell	甲	6			

漢字 by Stroke Count

2 Strokes		5 Strokes		赤	12	10 Strokes	
又	12	失	3	8 Strokes		時	7
3 Strokes		甲	6	学	11	訓	9
弓	4	6 Strokes		押	9	馬	4
4 Strokes		年	10	英	8	11 Strokes	
引	5	氣	7	9 Strokes		週	5
近	3	7 Strokes		秒	6	13 Strokes	
		来	10			意	11
						話	8